



Kenya: status report

Status report · edition of 2026-08-06

<https://corpus.data-landscapers.com/reports/KEN/KEN-status-2026-08-06.pdf>

Compiled 2026-08-06 from the Data Landscapers source base, from `outputs/reports/KEN/ledger.csv` (134 systems and instruments, 4 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. **Not held** — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Kenya has a data-protection statute in force since 2019, a mobile-money rail that moved KES 41.68tn in the year to March 2026, an identity register the Interior Ministry reports as holding more than 42 million digitised records, and a government services platform carrying over 22,000 services. It has no adopted artificial-intelligence instrument, no national count of registered data controllers, and no cloud region in commercial service. The state's own digital spending fell for a second consecutive year, to **KSh 8.6bn for 2026/27** from KSh 16.3bn in 2024/25. The National AI Strategy 2025-2030 is costed at KSh 152bn over five years and **carries no dedicated allocation** in that budget. Service migration onto the eCitizen platform ran at **1,695 of a target 11,000** in the year to 31 March 2026, against 3,458 the year before.

Infrastructure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS	AS AT
Airtel Nxtra data centre, Tatu City	In development	Completion deferred to July 2027
Baobab Cloud sovereign public cloud	Implemented	Launched May 2026
Broadcast Logger and CA Broadcast Monitoring Room	Implemented	Joint CA and KFCB user training concluded 2026-07-27
Communications Equipment Distributor licence	Implemented	CA public notice 2026-07-21 under Gazette Notice 3335
Digital Superhighway fibre and hotspot targets	In development	Targets restated for 2026 by the ICT Authority
iXAfrica NBOX1 campus	Implemented	20MW expansion financed September 2025
Kenya Advanced Institute of Science and Technology	In development	Korea Exim Bank operationalisation review, August 2026
Kenya Cyber Resilience Project	Implemented	Launched January 2026
Kenya-Tanzania Terrestrial Fibre Link	Implemented	Launched at Lunga Lunga and Horohoro 2026-07-29
Konza National Data Centre	Implemented, expansion in PPP procurement	Transaction-advisory procurement open at FY2026/27 budget day

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS	AS AT
LINX Nairobi internet exchange	Implemented	Angani joined the Nairobi hub, July 2026
Meta Daraja subsea cable	In development	Safaricom named landing and operating partner, October 2025
Microsoft-G42 Olkaria data centre	Planned, stalled	May 2026 launch missed, Treasury clearance failed
National Cyber Security Agency	Implemented	Order gazetted as Legal Notice 89 on 2026-05-15
Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Nairobi region	In development	Sovereign Cloud Region Government Summit held, still no launch date
president.go.ke	Implemented, twice breached	Defaced 2026-07-18, restored 2026-07-20
Safaricom 25-year unified licence	Implemented	Granted 2026-05
Starlink Direct-to-Cell with Airtel Kenya	Piloting	Pilot declared complete, CA approval awaited
Starlink Kenya fixed broadband	Implemented, capacity-capped	New sign-ups suspended in seven counties 2026-07-07
TouchNet Zadara AI Sovereign Cloud	Implemented	Launched at iXAfrica 2025-07-17
CA spectrum-interference audit, direct-to-cell	Not held	Opened 2026-03-10, conclusion put at mid-2026
Data-centre power tariff or grid-connection framework	Not held	No instrument found

Satellite broadband reached 24,999 subscribers and 0.9% of the fixed market by March 2026, and the operator then **suspended new sign-ups across seven counties**, diverting orders to a deposit-backed waitlist, with median download speeds down 26% year on year to 34.55 Mbps. Traffic across the London Internet Exchange's Nairobi and Mombasa points **rose twentyfold in a year to 330 Gbps**, with 55 or more networks connected. Against the 100,000km national fibre target, the only delivered figures published are the regulator's for the universal-service-funded slice: **2,193km under phase one and 1,173 last-mile sites under phase two** at 30 June 2025.

The US\$1bn Microsoft and G42 facility at Olkaria missed a May 2026 launch and the project's **full 1GW draw is about a third of Kenya's roughly 3GW supply**. No data-centre tariff, gazetted large-load connection rule or grid-priority instrument is held, so every power arrangement on record is bilateral to one project. The National Treasury told transaction advisers in April 2026 that the Konza National Data Centre runs **706 kW of certified capacity at an actual load of about 300 kW, with 100 of its 144 racks in use** and hosts 145 of 451 government institutions; its expansion to 288 racks drew no appropriation at the 2026/27 budget and is being structured as a public-private partnership.

The National Cyber Security Agency Order was gazetted as Legal Notice 89 on 2026-05-15 and **announced as approved on 2026-06-22**, at a tabled establishment cost of about KSh 4bn. The presidency's own website was **defaced on 2026-07-18 with a 5 BTC ransom demand and restored on 2026-07-20**, the second compromise inside twelve months; cause, access vector and attribution are undisclosed.

Digital public infrastructure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS	AS AT
Airtel Money Bizna Wallet	Implemented	Launched 2026-08-03
Ardhisasa land platform	Implemented	Isiolo County onboarded
Automatic identity at 18 from the civil register	In development	Births and Deaths Registration (Amendment) Act assented

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS	AS AT
Biometric Health Identification	Implemented	Dependants aged 7 to 17 enrolled under the Social Health Authority
CBK national switch and fast payment system	In development	Bidder contest opens between Kenswitch-Visa, Pesalink and NIBSS
Civil register link to police facial recognition	Planned	Tender up to KSh 25bn, six cities
Compulsory digital seller identifier	Planned	Proposed in digital trade policy reform
County digital services register	Implemented, a dated assessment rather than a maintained register	Vision 2030 rapid assessment published 2026-02-23
Diaspora information management portal	Implemented	Launched on eCitizen
Digital birth-notification system	Piloting	Nairobi County first, Nairobi Hospital live
Digital Health Act 2023 and Digital Health Agency	Implemented, under appeal	Health Information Management Procedures Regulations 2025 operationalise it
e-Government Procurement system	Implemented	Go-live scheduled July 2025
eCitizen operating consortium	Implemented, under challenge	Auditor-General recommends handover to the State
eCitizen platform	Implemented	Briefed to the Public Accounts Committee on the special audit
eCitizen service-migration target	Implemented	Controller of Budget report to 31 March 2026
Hustler Fund repayment through Bonga Points	Implemented	Live, KSh 3m recovered in the first week
IEBC iris capture on voter-registration kits	In development	Optional iris added ahead of the 2027 poll
Kenya DPI Roadmap	In development	Technical-assistance tender issued, offers close 2026-09-01
Kenya Education Management Information System	In development	Pilot from July 2025, full go-live targeted September 2025
Kenya Ports Authority digitalisation	Planned	South Korea affirms support
Kirinyaga One Government Network fibre	Implemented	Five sub-counties connected
KNBS digital-indicator release	Implemented	Economic Survey 2025 published, ICT chapter covering 2020 to 2024
KNPHI enterprise system interoperability baseline	In development	Tender addenda, bids closing 2026-08-05
M-PESA	Implemented	Audited results for the year to 31 March 2026
M-PESA business tariff schedule	Implemented	Revised schedule effective 2026-08-07
M-PESA phone-number masking	Piloting	Person-to-person masking live from 2026-03-24
Maisha Namba national digital ID	Implemented	42m identity records digitised in FY2025/26
Murang'a telemedicine network	Implemented	Launched 2026-05-28
My OneApp	Implemented	Launched April 2026
National Police Service Information Management System	In development	Design presented to the Inspector-General
New identity and passport issuance system	Planned	Procurement announced, ten-day identity-card target
Online download of birth certificates	Implemented	Announced by the Interior Cabinet Secretary

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS	AS AT
Pesalink and PAPSS interlink	Implemented	Pesalink joined PAPSS as technical connectivity provider
Phone number as personal digital identifier	Implemented	Milimani High Court judgment, March 2026
Public Finance Management (e-Citizen) Regulations 2026	In development	Out for public comment
Safaricom and KNBS mobile-data partnership	Planned	Announced at the Global Data Festival
Social Health Authority claims platform	Implemented, failing at the counter	Teachers' union raises authorisation failures
Verifiable-credential wallet, Public Service Commission	Piloting	Proof-of-concept completed with Cybernetica and the Tony Blair Institute
Ward ICT hubs	In development	285 of 1,450 built since 2024
National earth-observation data programme	Not held	No Kenyan instrument on file

The Interior Ministry reports **more than 42 million identity records digitised** in 2025/26, with biometric health enrolment extended to dependants aged 7 to 17. Registered mobile-money accounts reached **94.09 million with 564,330 active agents in May 2026**, from 87.46 million and 451,157 in August 2025. A High Court ruling of March 2026 **recognised a registered phone number as a personal digital identifier**, barred recycling dormant numbers without consent, and gave the Attorney-General six months to legislate; that window closes about September 2026 and nothing on file shows a framework tabled.

eCitizen carries **more than 22,000 services from over 100 agencies** and collects KSh 600m a day, while the Auditor-General alleges KSh 9.4bn was irregularly routed to private entities. A teachers' union reported members **turned away and billed in cash** when health-claims authorisation failed, with the Authority answering that the Digital Health Agency runs the system on its behalf. Kenya's clearest written interoperability requirement is a procurement document: the health ministry's enterprise-system tender **makes financial, tax, insurance, pensions, payroll, laboratory and identity interfaces day-one mandatory** and requires primary hosting inside an approved Kenyan government or health-sector environment.

The Vision 2030 Delivery Secretariat scored all 47 counties on service automation, revenue systems and data use in February 2026, **from 98.3 for Murang'a to 28.8 for Wajir**, with six counties graded as reliant on manual and cash-based systems — a desk review, not a survey of users. The national DPI roadmap is still unpublished; GIZ **tendered technical assistance on 2026-07-31 to develop a bankable Kenyan digital public infrastructure project**, with offers closing 2026-09-01.

Governance and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS	AS AT
Access to Information (Amendment) Bill	In development	Bill reported 2026-07-02
AI Governance Act	Planned	Provided for in the draft AI policy
Central bank pricing principles for mobile money	Implemented	Operator tariff cut effective 2026-08-07 attributed to alignment
Communications Equipment Vendor Class Licence guidelines	Implemented	Rules introduced, reported 2026-07-23
Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act 2018	Implemented, sections struck down	Court of Appeal struck the false-publication sections
Copyright and Related Rights Bill 2026	In development	Out for public comment

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS	AS AT
Data Protection Act 2019	Implemented	Since 2019
Draft National Data Governance Policy	In development	Still to be completed on the ICT principal secretary's forward list
EU Global Gateway ICT standards engagement	Planned	Principal-secretary-level meeting with the EU delegation
Harmonised county wayleave framework	In development	Agreed between the ICT and Devolution departments
ICT Authority Bill	In development	Named as a priority to advance
Inter-Agency Digital Piracy Enforcement Framework	Implemented	Adopted on the steering committee's 100-day report
Joint Framework for Digital Platform Governance	In development	UNESCO and regulator technical review, 6 to 7 July 2026
Kenya Intellectual Property Bill	In development	Named alongside the Copyright Bill
National BPO Policy	Implemented	Claimed delivered on the ICT principal secretary's milestone list
National Cloud Policy	Implemented	Cloud-first mandate for the public sector
National Cybersecurity Policy	Planned	Named as still to be developed
National data marketplace	Planned	Provided for in the draft Data Governance Policy
National Policy on Digital Piracy	Planned	Announced as a next step
ODPC draft guidance notes on biometric and children's data	In development	Issued in draft 2025-05-19
ODPC draft guidance on offshore AI processing	In development	Draft note published, reported 2026-08-04
ODPC five-year privacy plan	Implemented	Launched July 2025
ODPC quality management system	In development	Launched 2026-07-14, phased toward certification
Persons with Disabilities Act 2025	Implemented	In force, no AI accessibility standard attached
Sexual Offences Act amendment package	Planned	Justice-sector committee proposals reported 2026-08-04
Technopolis Act	Implemented	Enacted, reported 2026-05-13
Technopolis Regulations	In development	Named as still to be finalised
US-Kenya Health Cooperation Framework	Implemented, under litigation	Court of Appeal reversed the consumer-federation suspension
Virtual Asset Service Providers Act 2025	Implemented	Commenced 2025-11-04
Virtual Asset Service Providers Regulations 2026	Implemented	Gazetted 2026-07-22

Virtual assets acquired a statute commenced on 2025-11-04 and **regulations gazetted as Legal Notice 134 on 2026-07-22**, setting paid-up capital by licence class from KES 300m for stablecoin issuance to nil for investment advisers; every existing operator must license afresh by 2026-11-04. The state's proposed data marketplace would **license anonymised platform and statistics-office datasets**, targeting more than 1,000 datasets over five years at up to KSh 396m, with the pricing method deferred.

Data Protection Services received **KSh 917.3m in the 2026/27 original estimates**, its first separately visible appropriation. The regulator's own bulletin puts the caseload at **7,128 complaints received and 215 determinations issued to March 2025**, with penalties imposed on 10 entities and no later total published. Of 224 betting

and gaming firms it identified, **15 were fully registered** and 185 were given 40 days to register or lose their licences in May 2026; the gambling regulator confirmed in August 2026 that it is **investigating three licensed operators** on a complaint dated 2026-05-19. The data-protection regulator is meanwhile reaching artificial intelligence through transfer rules rather than an AI instrument: draft guidance reported on 2026-08-04 would require **a lawful transfer basis, a documented adequacy assessment and a written processing agreement** before personal data leaves Kenya for AI processing. The note itself is not held.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS	AS AT
Absa Kenya AI policy and Citrus agent	Piloting	2025 sustainability report published 2026-07-29
ATLAS Umoja AI	In development	Launched at the ATU conference, 23 to 24 July 2026
Kenya AI and Other Emerging Technologies Policy 2026	In development	Consultation closed 2026-08-04
Kenya Artificial Intelligence Bill 2026	In development	Before the Senate, mid-2026
Kenya-China e-commerce cooperation memorandum	Implemented	Eighteen ICT officers dispatched to Shandong
Kenya-Germany applied AI centre	Planned	Preliminary consultations in Nairobi 2026-02-03
Kenya-India-Italy sovereign AI partnership	Planned	Trilateral launched at the India AI Impact Summit
Konza Digital Media City and AI data centre	Planned	Meeting with Korea Exim Bank on a next Konza phase
National AI computing platform	In development	Progress agreed with UNDP 2026-07-28
National AI Strategy 2025-2030	Implemented	Implementation roadmap published February 2026
OpenAI Academy Nairobi	Planned	Talks disclosed at the G7 sidelines
Qubit Hub	Planned	Hosting collaboration announced 2026-05-25
Safaricom and AWS generative AI collaboration	Implemented	Expanded collaboration announced 2025-06-05
Safaricom automated decisioning and Zuri	Implemented, under constitutional challenge	High Court petition filed 2026-04-23
Servernah Cloud	Implemented	Launched at iXAfrica March 2026
Vumah Labs	Implemented, scale unestablished	Founder profile published 2026-07-21
Zerobionics	Implemented	Founder interview published 2026-07-17

Kenya's artificial-intelligence position rests on a draft, a bill and a strategy without money. The **draft AI and Other Emerging Technologies Policy** runs to 226 pages, was open for comment from 2026-07-21 to 2026-08-04, and asserts **effects-based jurisdiction over any entity outside Kenya** whose AI outputs have direct and foreseeable effects in the country while leaving "high risk" undefined and stating no penalties. Its labour chapter sets minimum standards for content moderators, data annotators and evaluators — pay transparency, psychosocial support, grievance procedures — binding on international firms operating through outsourcing partners, **against a reported wage range of US\$1.46 to US\$3.74 an hour** for Kenyan moderators. A separate Artificial Intelligence Bill sits before the Senate on a different legislative track, and the National AI Strategy is costed at **KSh 152bn over five years with no dedicated budget allocation**.

Deployment is running ahead of the rules that would govern it. A constitutional petition filed on 2026-04-23 alleges that automated M-PESA decisioning and the operator's chatbot **offer no guaranteed route to a human agent, no disclosure of decision logic and algorithmic discrimination in credit scoring**; respondents had not filed at publication. Venture funding fell sharply: Kenyan startups raised **US\$126m in the first half of 2026, third in Africa and the weakest half since early 2021**, against US\$1.04bn across 2025. No held source states Kenya's installed AI compute capacity at any date.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS	AS AT
Digital hubs establishment appropriation	Implemented	FY2026/27 allocation of KSh 400m
Digital Literacy Programme	Implemented, no outturn published since 2022	Government-steered review published 2022
EmpowerHer	Implemented	Tana River county dialogue 2026-07-27
Enhancing Digital Access and Community Resilience	Implemented, completion date passed	Scheduled completion March 2026
EU digitalisation of technical and vocational education	Implemented	Contracted 2023, running to 2028
EU Last Mile Connectivity of Schools	Implemented	Contracted 2023, running to 2028
EU-Kenya Digital Partnership	Implemented	Commitment announced 2026-06-09
EU-UNICEF school connectivity	Implemented	EU-funded phase launched October 2023
FY2027/28 budget process	In development	Preparation process launched 2026-07-24
HerSpace	Implemented	Opened as the successor programme, July 2026
Hustler Fund	Implemented, funding withdrawn	Loyalty-point repayment opened, July 2026
Jitume Digital Enablement Programme	Implemented	117th hub commissioned 2026-07-20
KenSafeSpace	Discontinued	Close-out workshop 2026-07-28
Kenya Digital Economy Acceleration Project	Implemented	FY2026/27 appropriation of KSh 4.3bn
KfW digitalisation of vocational training	Implemented	Committed 2025, running to 2030
KfW promotion of vocational training in ICT	Implemented	Committed 2020, scheduled to end 2026
Last-mile county connectivity maintenance appropriation	Implemented	FY2026/27 allocation of KSh 528m
Mastercard Foundation EdTech Fellowship	Implemented	Cohort 4 of 12 Kenyan startups selected 2026-07-29
Regulator school computer donations	Implemented	Turkana donation 2026-07-30
Safaricom Hook Circle	Implemented	Cumulative reach passed one million
Starlink school connectivity with GrowX and CEMASTEAs	Implemented	30 schools connected at the start of the 2026 academic year
UK Digital Access Programme, Kenya	Implemented	Bilateral phase launched 2024, running to March 2027
Universal Service Fund	Implemented	Delivery reported for FY2024/25 in the regulator's annual report
Vote 1122, State Department for ICT and the Digital Economy	Implemented	FY2026/27 original estimates of KSh 12,763.8m
Ajira Digital Programme	Not held	No dated statement on file

The digital thematic allocation fell to **KSh 8.6bn for 2026/27** from KSh 12.7bn and KSh 16.3bn in the two preceding years, and KSh 4.3bn of it — half the thematic — is the World Bank's Digital Economy Acceleration Project, which had **disbursed US\$33.93m of a US\$390m commitment** at a portal reading of 2026-06-24.

The Jitume digital hub programme **commissioned its 117th hub on 2026-07-20** on the ceremony series while its own officials give an installed base of about 350, and no hub register has been published. Six donor programmes carry commitment values and no disbursement or outturn at any date. The universal service fund **connected 20 sub-locations in 2024/25 and 155 cumulatively, reaching about 508,012 people**; the Digital Literacy Programme **installed 1,170,846 devices in 22,891 public primary schools** but had connected 216 schools to the internet when a government-steered review last reported in 2022.

Smartphone connections **passed 50 million in March 2026**, with feature phones down to 28.5 million. The Hustler Fund has disbursed KSh 83bn against KSh 71bn recovered on a 15% default rate, while state funding fell from KSh 20bn at launch to **KSh 300m in the year to June 2026**, and repayment is now accepted in privately issued loyalty points. The KenSafeSpace digital-rights coalition **closed on 2026-07-28** after 30 months on a EUR 1.3m grant, its 49 members continuing unfunded. The Mastercard Foundation's EdTech Fellowship **moved from eight-month growth-stage cohorts to an 18-month early-stage programme** in July 2026, selecting 12 Kenyan startups at up to US\$100,000 each.

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
CA spectrum-interference audit, direct-to-cell	a published CA determination or gazette notice would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, no CA determination or gazette notice on interference published; trade reporting only	2026-08-05
Data-centre power tariff or grid-connection framework	a published EPRA or Kenya Power data-centre tariff, or a gazetted large-load connection rule, would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, EPRA tariffs and open-access regulations carry no data-centre category and no large-load connection rule	2026-08-05
National earth-observation data programme	a Kenya Space Agency strategy or national earth-observation data policy would settle it; every satellite-data source the place holds is continental or vendor-side; probed 2026-08-05, KSA Strategic Plan 2023-2027 located; the EO Data Sharing Framework 2026 itself is a landing page only	2026-08-05
Registered data controllers and processors	the ODPC register or its annual report would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, the statutory register is public and live; a total needs pagination traversal, not a single fetch	2026-08-05
Installed AI compute capacity	no held source states Kenya's installed GPU or accelerator capacity; a ministry or regulator inventory would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, no ministry or regulator inventory exists; the nearest official statement is a Konza transaction document giving 0.7MW IT capacity, 144 racks and no dedicated GPU clusters; on ingest the Konza transaction document proved to be dated 2026-04-13, not 2020, so its 0.7MW / 144-rack / no-GPU-cluster statement is current rather than historical	2026-08-05
Ajira Digital Programme	the state's other flagship digital-work programme is effectively absent from the base; probed 2026-08-05, no official programme report retrievable and ajiradigital.go.ke renders only a broken interface; an SSRN case study is the only first-hand document reached	2026-08-05

No Communications Authority determination on the direct-to-cell spectrum-interference review has appeared since it opened in March 2026. No data-centre power tariff or gazetted large-load connection rule exists, and no earth-observation data programme is on file. No inventory states Kenya's installed AI compute

capacity. The data-protection register is public but paginated, so no national total for registered controllers and processors is established, and no official report on the Ajira Digital Programme has been published at any date.

About this document

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